to create these jars was called 'pygg' (which back then was pronounced pug). Over the next five hundred or so years three things happened that caused us to end up with the piggy bank. Firstly, the pronunciation of the jars themselves changed so that instead of sounding like pug, these jars started being pronounced 'pig'. Secondly, over a few hundred years, people slowly forgot that pygg once referred to the clay used in these jars. And finally, the culmination was a merchant in the nineteenth century discovering these jars, thinking they were a great idea and sending an order for hundreds of 'pygg jars' to an English factory. When the English potters received the request, they naturally but incorrectly created money saving jars in the shape of a pig. The merchant decided to sell them anyway, they were an immediate hit with customers and children, and our modern day childhood Money Story, that a pig equals savings, was born.

Other than being an interesting story, what does the origin of the piggy bank have to do with your finances? The answer is: Everything.

There are so many myths and messages that make up our Money Stories and that we accept as truths. Some are mistakes or myths, and some are right but may not be right for us. Part of uncovering your Money Story means uncovering what you believe about money for yourself. To help you make sense of this, we're going to work through some examples in this chapter.

A Money Story that is commonly accepted is the popular money myth that in order to become good at personal savings, you need to create and stick to a budget.

Now, chances are that's a myth that attracted you to this book in the first place. But if you don't quite believe me, please understand that research is proving that budgets don't work, in the same way we understand that diets don't work. Professor Elaine Kempson, Emeritus Professor from the University of Bristol in the UK, stumbled upon this. An international authority on consumer financial issues with over 30 years' experience in conducting research and contributing to policy development, Kempson confessed at the 2016 Good Shepherd Microfinance Financial Resilience Summit to being surprised by findings in her research that suggested budgets didn't work, but I for one wasn't surprised. That's because we're far better at focusing on healthy eating than restrictive dieting. Why should it be any different for our finances?